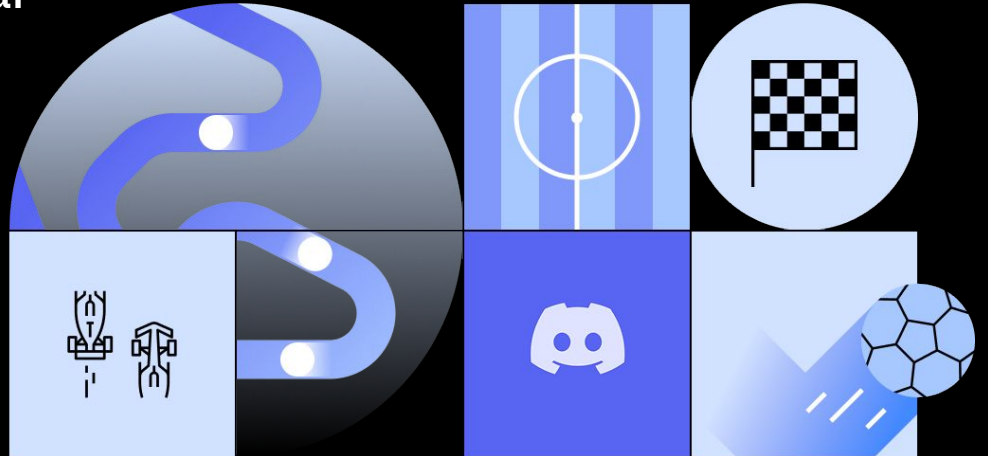
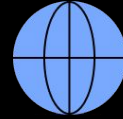


IBM SkillsBuild AI Builders Challenge

May Challenge & Lab Kickoff Webinar

Thursday, May 7th, 2026

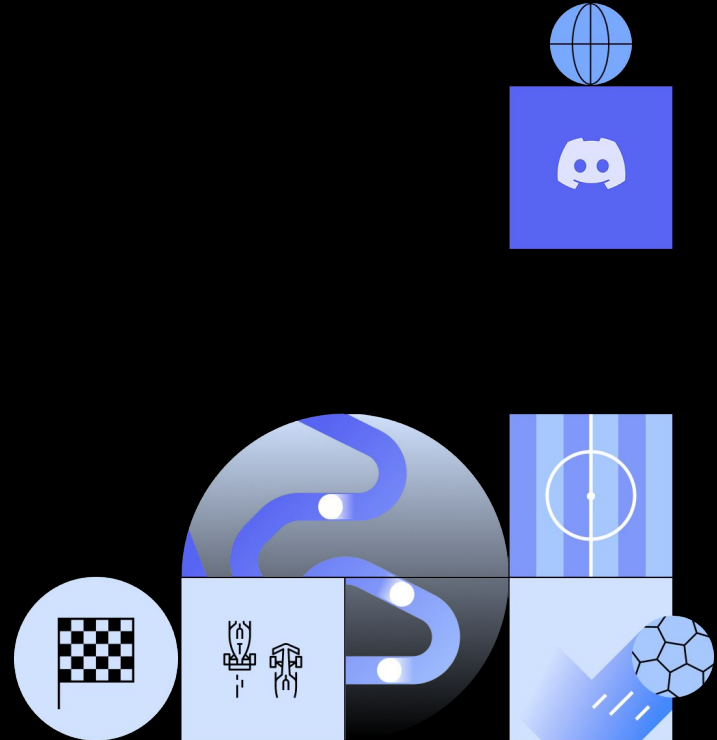
Sponsored by
IBM **SkillsBuild**



Welcome!

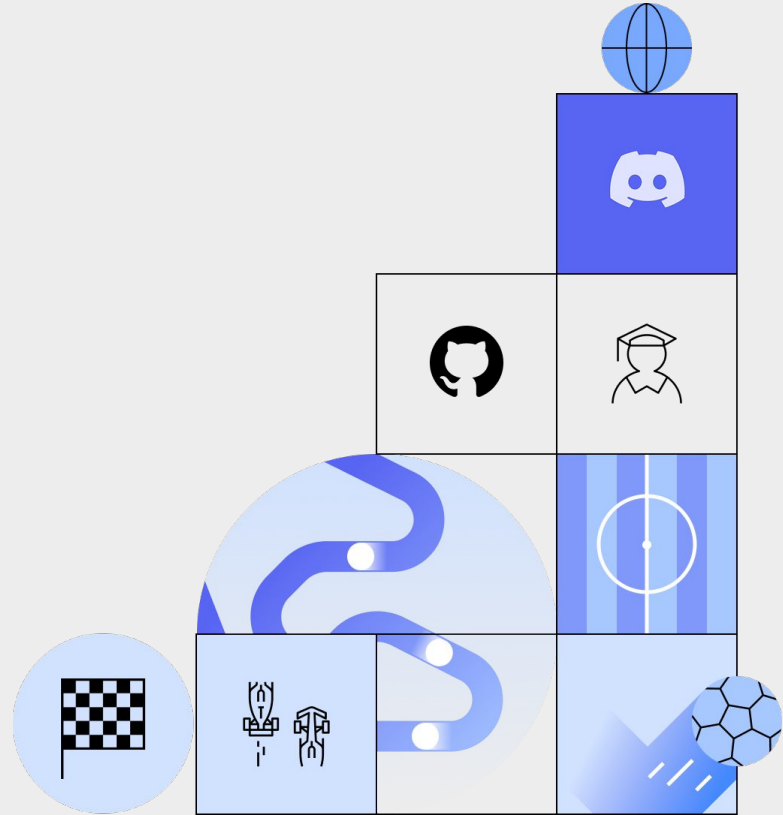
While we wait for others to join...feel free to introduce yourself in the chat!

- Your name
- What country/area you are from
- What university you currently attend



Agenda

1. Introductions
2. Program Overview
3. May Challenge & Lab
4. Tools & Resources
5. Github & Platform Walkthrough
6. Q&A



Your Challenge Support Team



Sydney C.

Challenge Program Manager

Main POC working with IBM team

Discord: @bemyapp



Lucas B.

Managing Director Production

Project Oversight & Hackathon Expert

Discord: @lucasbma



Makenna B.

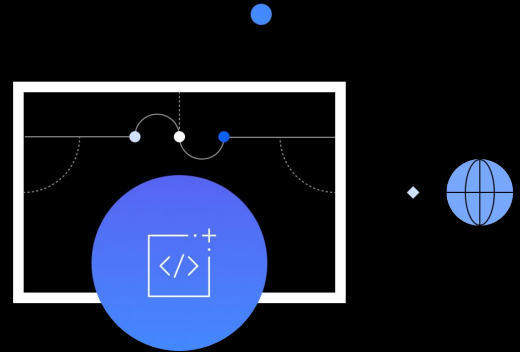
Communications Coordinator

Email/Discord Support & Questions

Discord: @makenna_bma

Program Overview

- **Build real AI projects** through two month long innovation challenges
- **Learn by doing** with hands-on GitHub labs
- **Compete for a piece of the \$15,000 total prize pool** and showcase your work
- **Connect with a global community** on Discord



How It Works

Learn

Accept your GitHub invite and complete the hands-on learning lab to build foundational AI skills



Build

Develop your own AI solution using IBM AI tools — solo or in a team of up to 5



Submit

Submit your project on the platform, including your GitHub repo, team members and demo video



Win

Earn prizes, recognition, and additional incentives throughout the challenge

Prizes & Incentives

\$15,000 Total Prize Pool

1st Place

\$2,250 USD

Runner Up

\$1,250 USD

Most Innovative

\$750 USD

Best Use of Tech

\$750 USD

Grand Prize

\$5,000 USD

Awarded to the top project across
both challenges

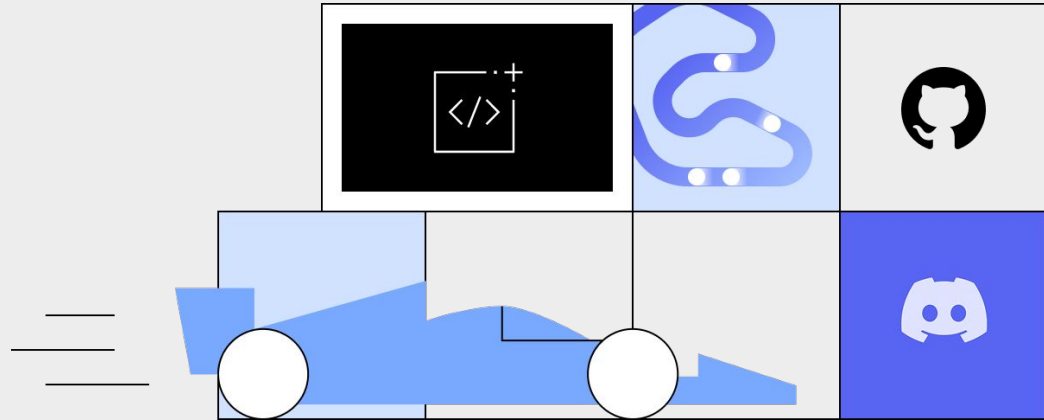
Incentives

\$50 Early Submission Bonus

First 10 teams to submit a
completed project page

This Month's Innovation Challenge & Learning Lab

AI Beyond the Finish Line



Important Links



Discord



Github



Platform

Github Learning Lab



Explore autonomous AI through hands-on simulation.

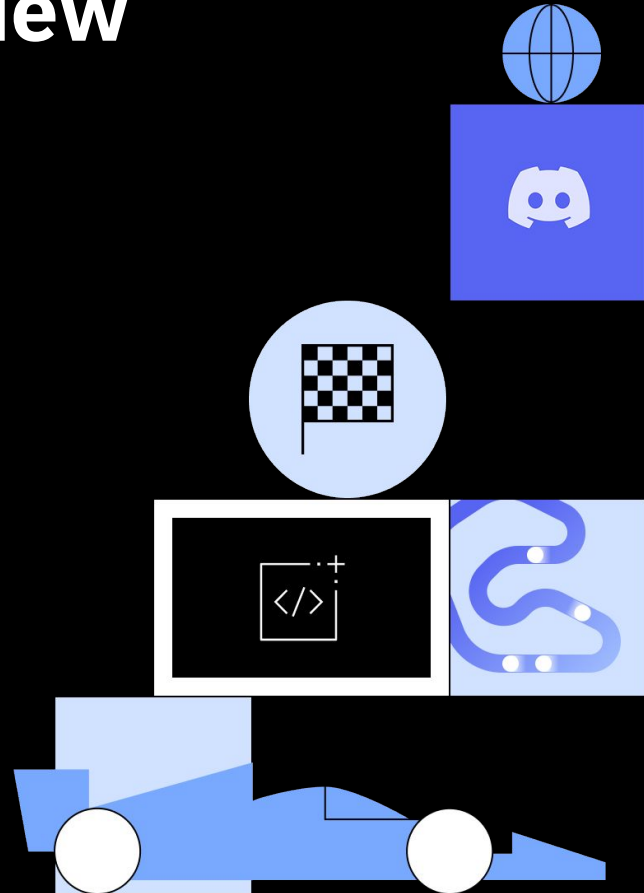
- Work in the GitHub lab to run and explore a baseline AI driver in TORCS
- Learn how autonomous systems sense, decide, and act in real time
- Modify code, experiment, and observe how behavior changes
- Document your results in your forked repository

```
lab/
├── README.md                # This README (you are here)
├── 01_torcs_lab/
│   ├── README_LAB.md       # Lab-specific overview
│   ├── 00_intro.md         # Conceptual introduction
│   ├── 01_torcs_lab.md     # Step-by-step learning lab
│   ├── 02_setup_guides/    # Setup and reference guides
│   ├── 03_build_your_own_container/ # Advanced path (optional)
│   ├── 04_files/           # TORCS and driver files
│   └── RESULTS.md          # Your results and reflections
```

Innovation Challenge Overview

Design and build an AI solution for real-world racing challenges.

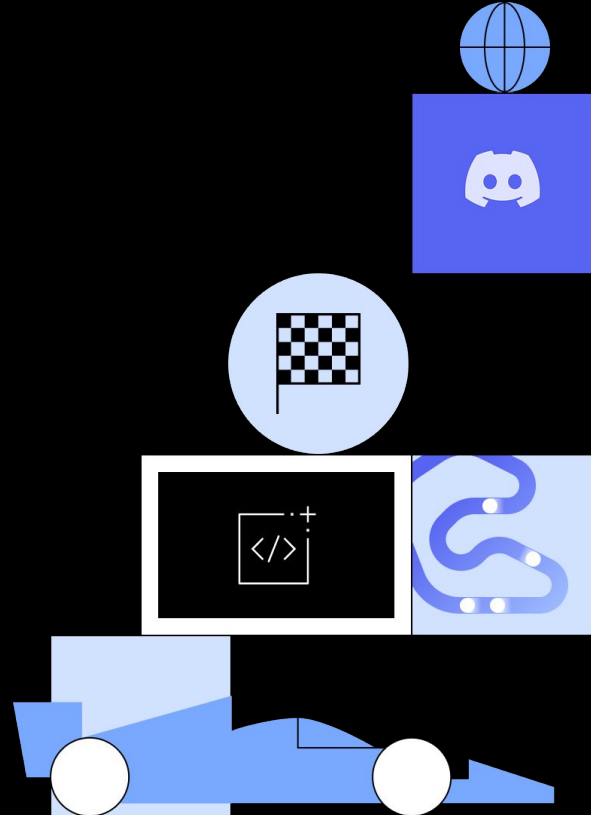
- Identify an opportunity to improve how teams, drivers, or fans experience racing
- Work with complex data and fast-moving decisions under real-world conditions
- Design a solution that turns data into actionable insights or meaningful experiences
- Demonstrate how AI can improve decision-making, understanding, and trust



Example Solution Areas

You are not limited to these — build any AI-powered solution that improves racing

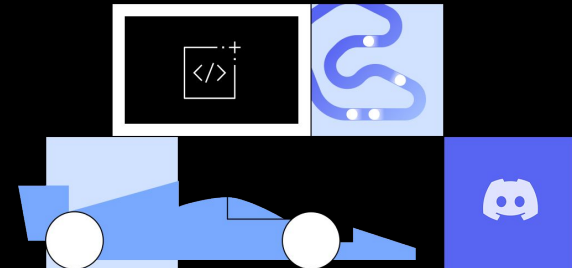
- **Strategy & Decision Support:** optimize race strategy and performance
- **Analytics:** analyze telemetry and race data
- **AI Assistants:** build copilots and feedback systems
- **Perception & Vision:** analyze track conditions and competitors
- **Fan Experience:** create engaging and understandable race experiences



Core Tools

You must use at least one IBM AI tool in your project (you're welcome to use additional tools as needed):

- **IBM Granite:** AI models for reasoning and generation
- **Docling:** Document data extraction and processing
- **Langflow:** Visual AI workflow builder
- **Context Forge:** Context management for AI systems
- **IBM Bob:** AI assistant to help you write and improve code



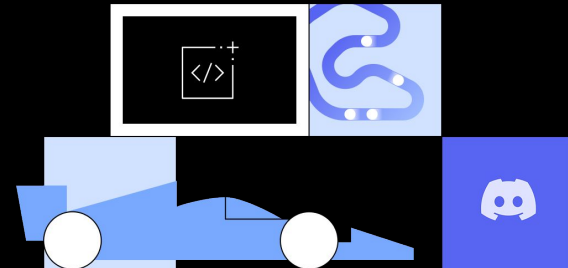
Submission Requirements

To be eligible, your project must include:

- 1. Use of IBM AI Tools:** At least one IBM-supported technology
- 2. Working Project:** A functioning prototype or proof of concept
- 3. Public GitHub Repository:** A public repo with your project code, README, and supporting files

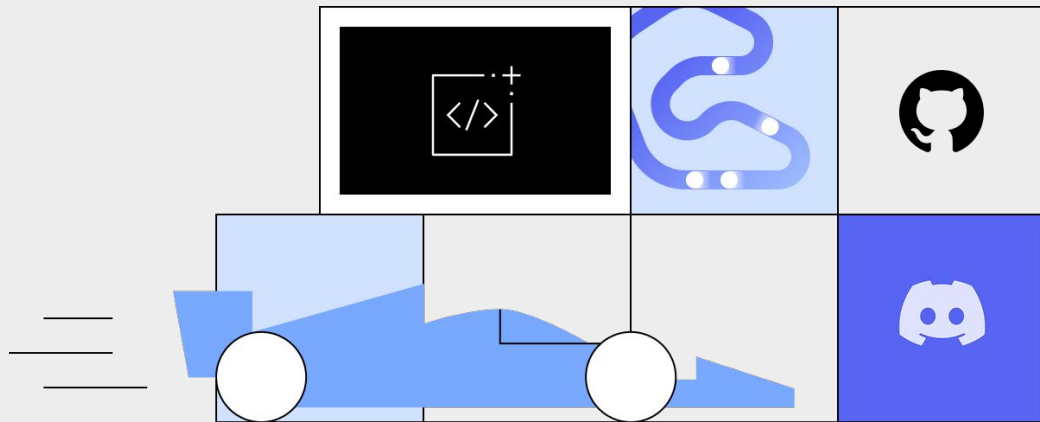
To complete your submission, your team must provide:

- 1. Github README:**
 - The problem you are solving
 - Your AI/technical approach
 - Why your solution matters in racing
- 2. Completed Project Page on the Platform:**
 - Project and team member details
 - Link to your project GitHub repository
 - A solution presentation video (max 3 minutes)



Demo

Github & Platform Overview



May Timeline

TODAY – Kickoff Webinar & Project Submission Page Opens

Tomorrow, Friday @ 9:30am ET – Team Formation Webinar

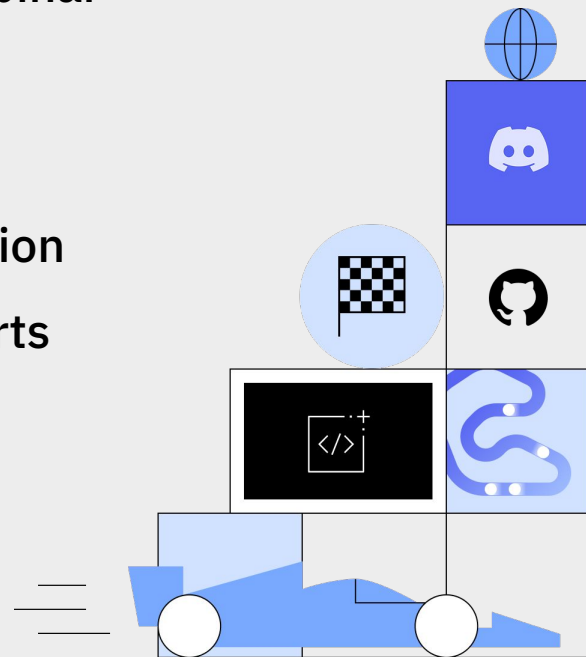
Monday @ 10am ET – IBM Tech Webinar

May 31st @ 11:59 PM ET – Project Submissions Due

Monday, June 1 - Friday, June, 5th – Judging Deliberation

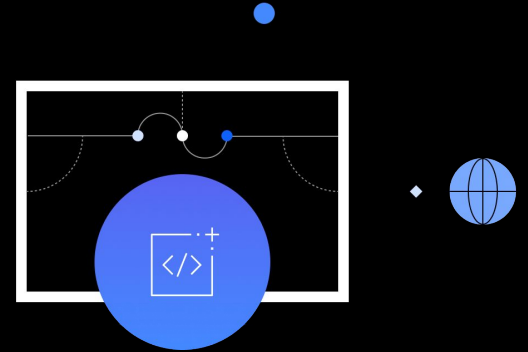
Monday, June 1st – June Challenge & Learning Lab Starts

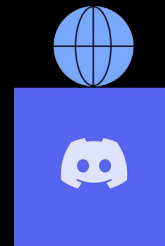
TBA – Winners Announcement Webinar



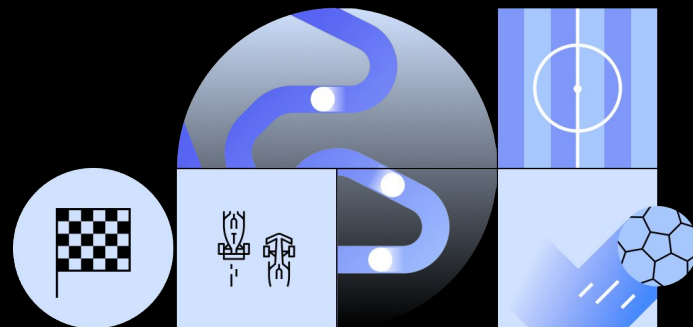
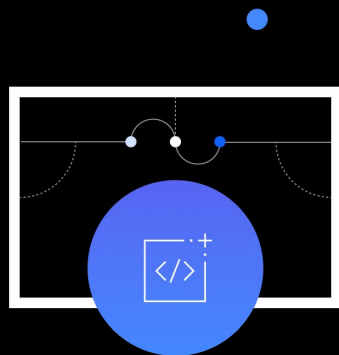
Questions?

Feel free to post any questions you have in the chat or reach out to us on the Discord `#support_channel`

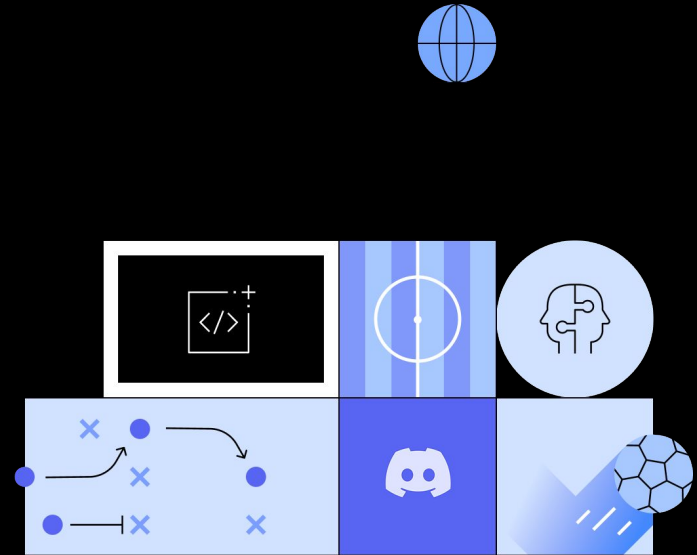
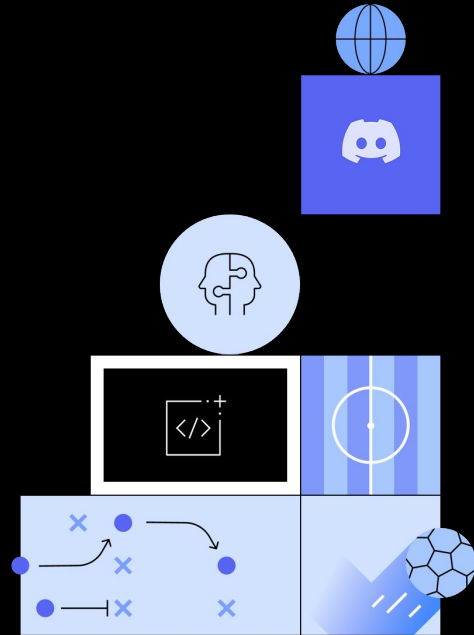




General Elements



June Elements



May Elements

